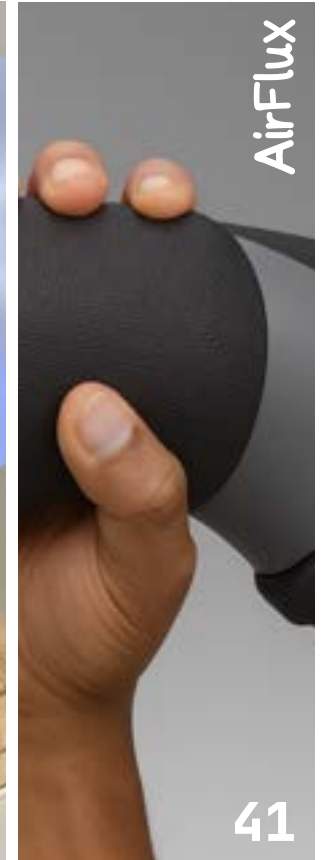


Nefeli Lemessiou

Nefeli Lemessiou

content



about me



Hello! I am **Nefeli** –
designing across **objects and interfaces**.

A designer trained in industrial design, working at the intersection of physical products and the interfaces that sit beside them. I'm drawn to briefs that take seriously the things people already live with, and to design products that feel effortless, useful, and considered.

BASED

London, UK

STATUS

Right to work · Pre-settled

EDUCATION

MA, RCA · BA Hons, Edinburgh

LOOKING FOR

Product / UX / Industrial

TOOLS

Figma, Blender, Arduino

LANGUAGES

English, Greek



***Tracking gut health
without increasing anxiety***

Onaka is a pocketable tactile device and companion app that turns symptom tracking into simple button presses, calming feedback, and daily reflections — without overwhelming charts.

November 2024 - July 2025

UX/UI · Tangible Interaction · Data Design ·
CMF · Research-Driven Design · Health

10-20%

of UK population
suffer from Irritable
Bowel Syndrome

20%

experience
Gastroesophageal
Reflux Disease

0.5%

are diagnosed with
an Inflammatory
Bowel Disease

PROBLEM Chronic GI conditions affect 1 in 5 in the UK, impacting physical health, mental well-being, and daily life.

INSIGHT 01 • GAO

Need for Better *Tool*.

Doctors and patients highlight a lack of simple, effective tools for tracking gut-related conditions.

INSIGHT 02 • CONNECTION

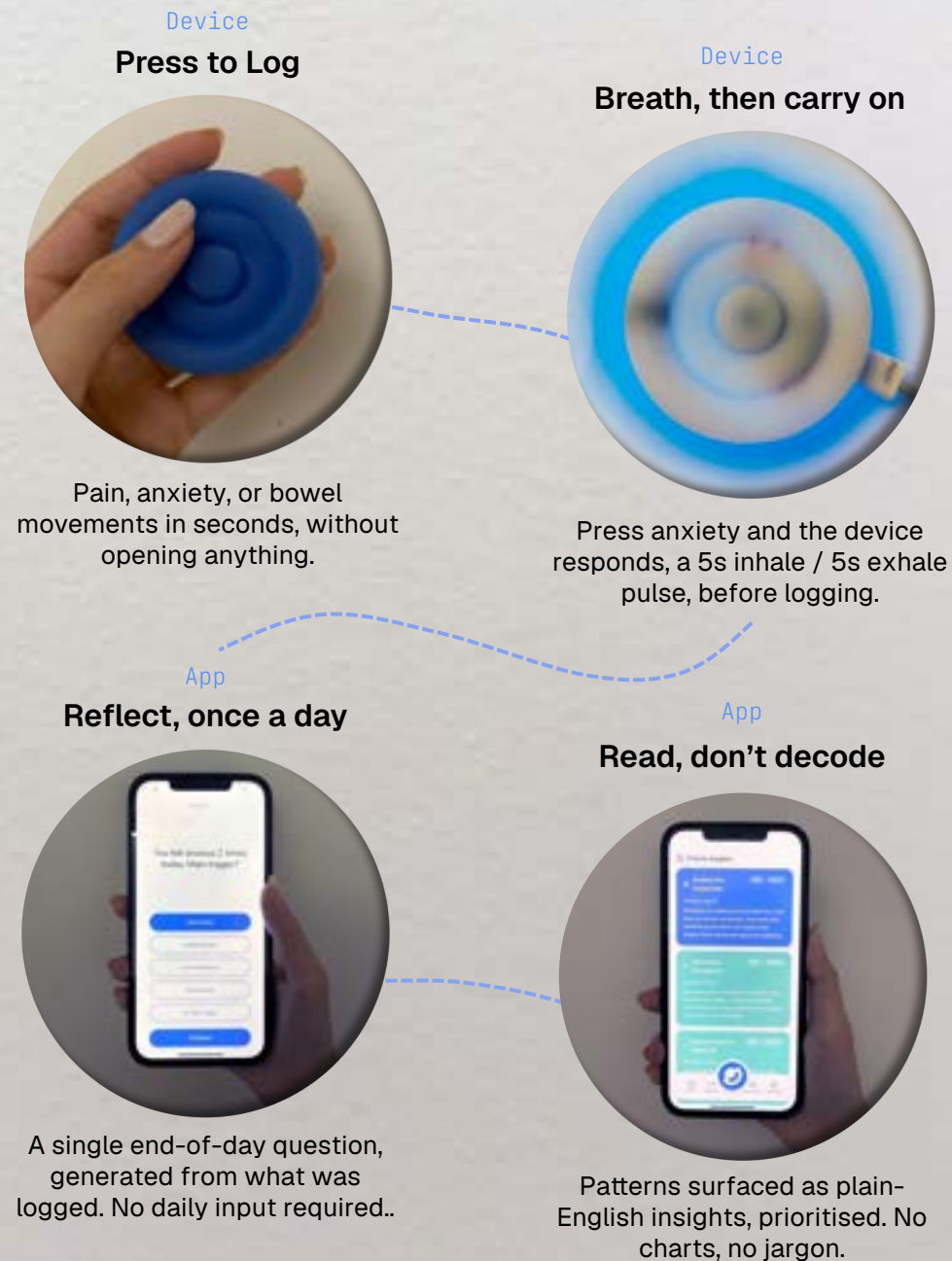
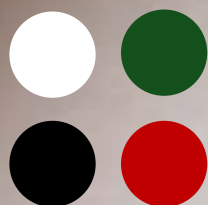
Gut – Brain Connection.

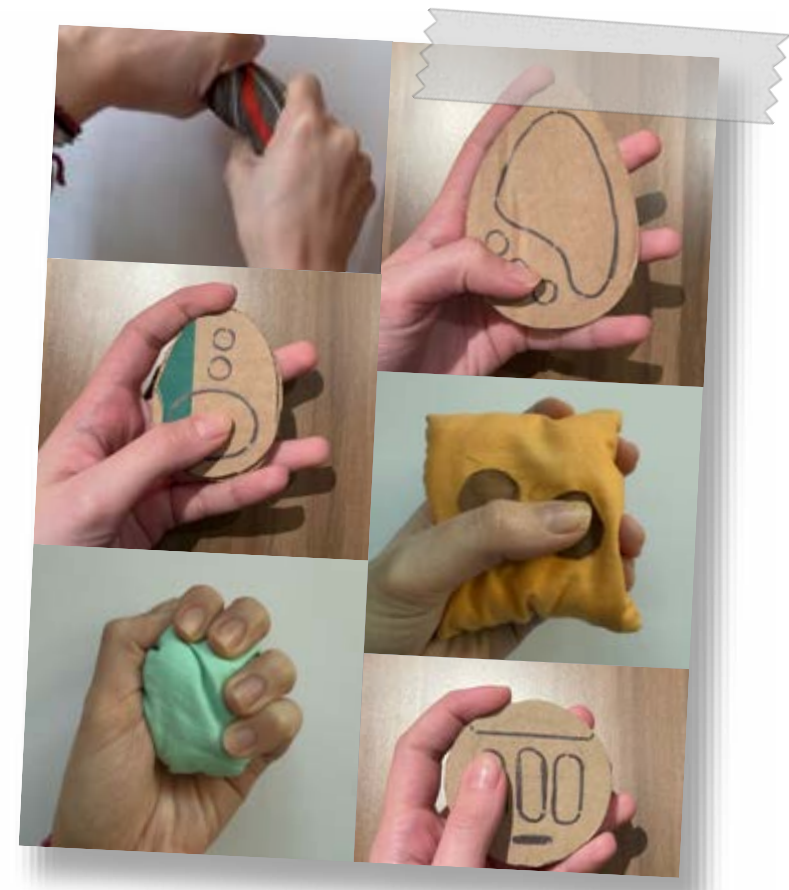
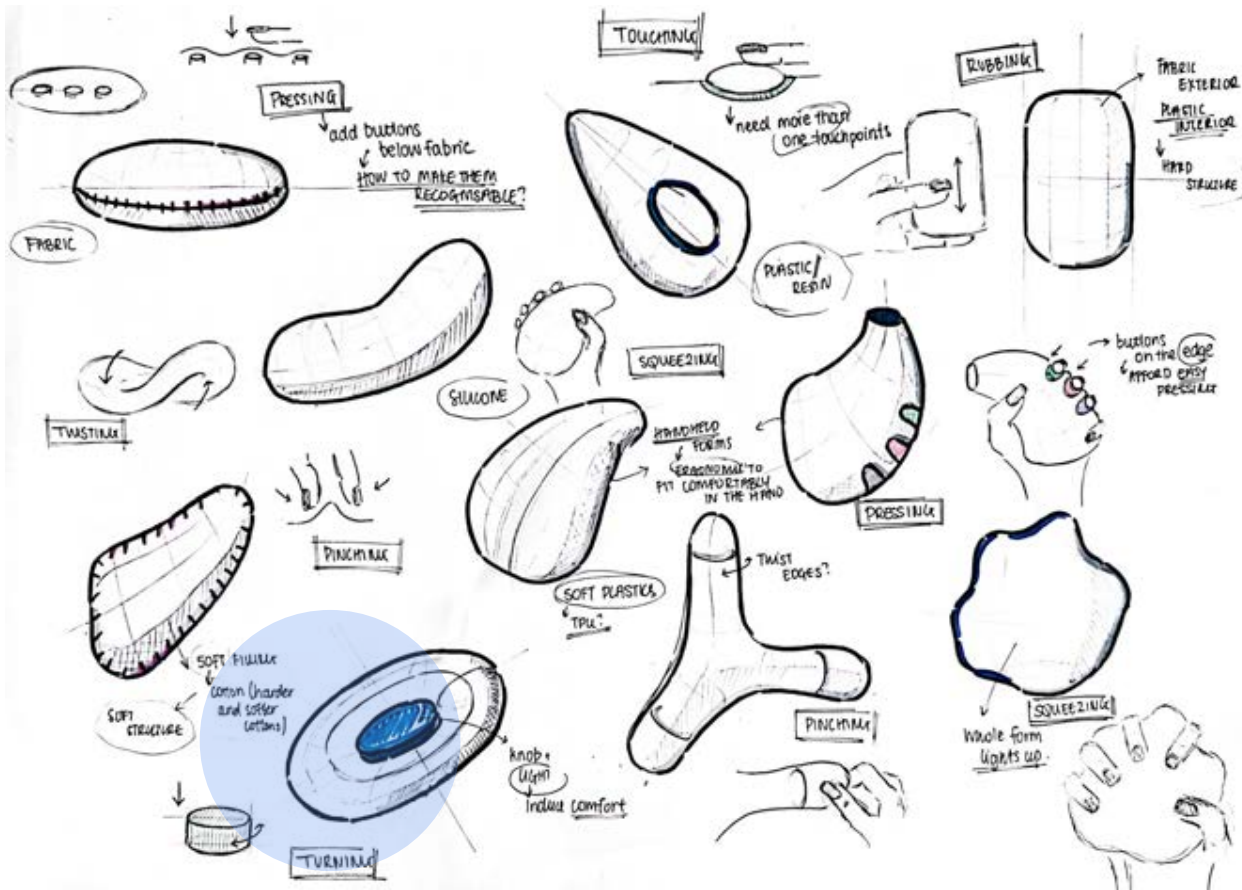
Stress and anxiety can worsen symptoms, as the gut is directly linked to the brain.

GI TRACKING APPS FALL SHORT

- **Cognitive overload** - Require frequent manual logging.
- **Symptom anticipation** - Constant tracking can heighten anxiety.
- **Complex data** - Graphs are often unclear or hard to interpret.
- **Lack of engagement** - Being phone-based makes them feel disconnected and less intuitive

INSIGHT Existing GI tracking tools are effortful, medicalised, and create hyper-awareness.
How might we capture symptoms in seconds—calmly—and return only the most helpful insights?





DECISION 01 • INPUT

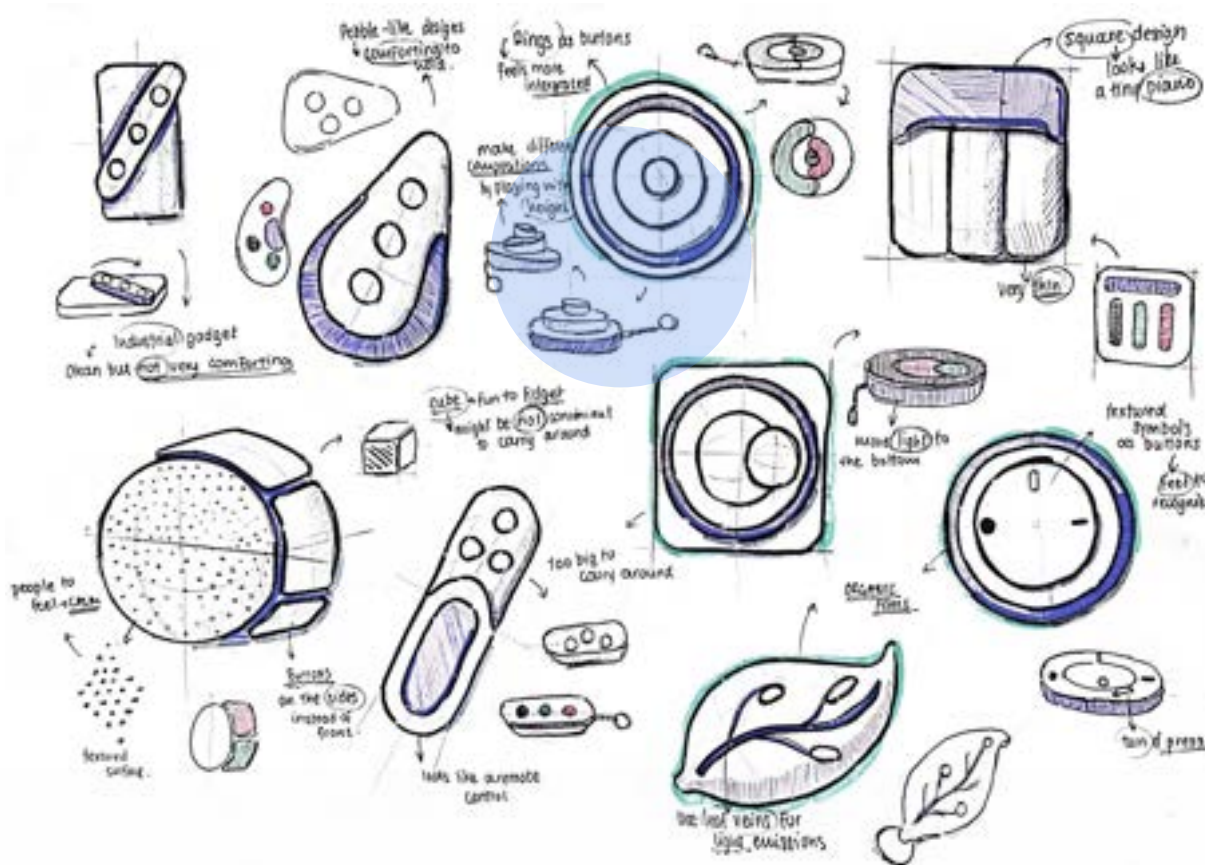
Buttons Over Gestures.

While gestures like squeezing and pinching were explored, buttons were chosen for their clear feedback and reassurance that input was successfully logged.

DECISIONS 02 • SYMPTOMS

Key *Symptom* Selection.

Pain, anxiety, and bowel movements were chosen based on healthcare input—they're spontaneous, easy to identify, low-effort to log, and often linked to other tracked factors.



DECISION 03 • FORM

Tactile *Circular* Design.

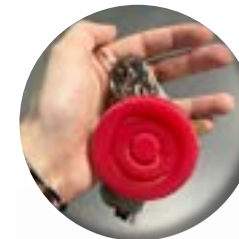
The concentric ring layout integrates buttons in an aesthetically pleasing way, with raised edges that guide the user's fingers—enabling use without needing to look at the device.



DECISION 03 • FORM

Discreet and *Private*.

Designed to blend into everyday life, Onaka is subtle and unrecognisable to others, allowing for discreet use and protecting the user's privacy.

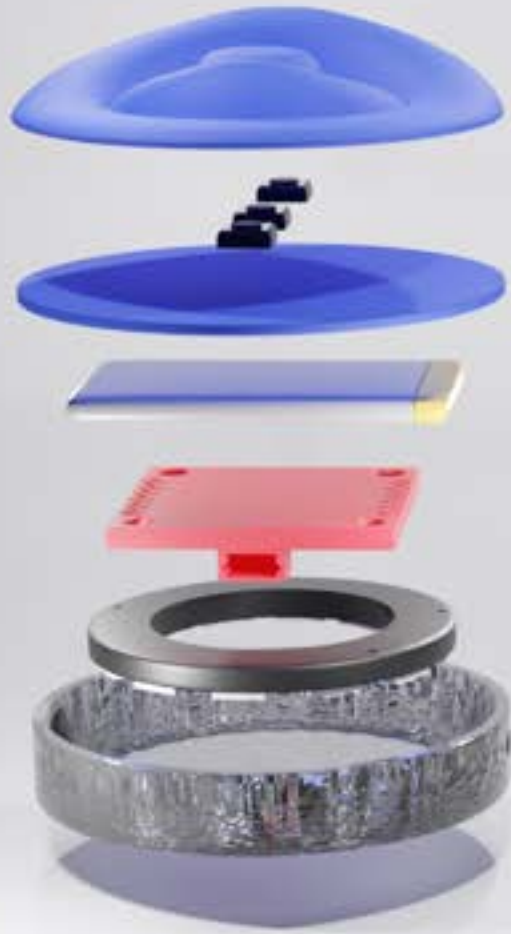


DECISION 04 • ATTACHMENT

Portable and Adaptable.

Includes a keychain attachment so it can easily be carried on keys or bags, offering flexibility in how users choose to keep it with them.





All data logged from the physical device is wirelessly transmitted to the companion app via a Wi-Fi-enabled system built into the Spark Fun microcontroller. The data is **securely sent and stored in the Blynk cloud** server, where the app accesses it through an API and displays it to the user.

01

Push Buttons.

Three buttons log symptoms (pain, anxiety, bowel movements), sending inputs directly to the app.

02

1200mAh Li-Po Battery.

Powers the device for portability and charges via USB-C through a 2-pin JST connector.

03

SparkFun Qwiic Board

A compact microcontroller that runs the code, enables internet connectivity, and syncs data with the app.

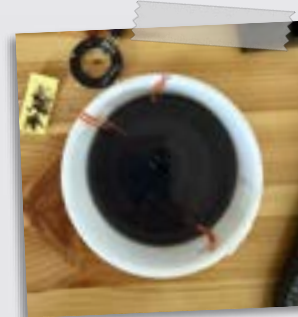
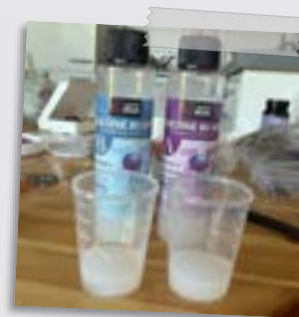
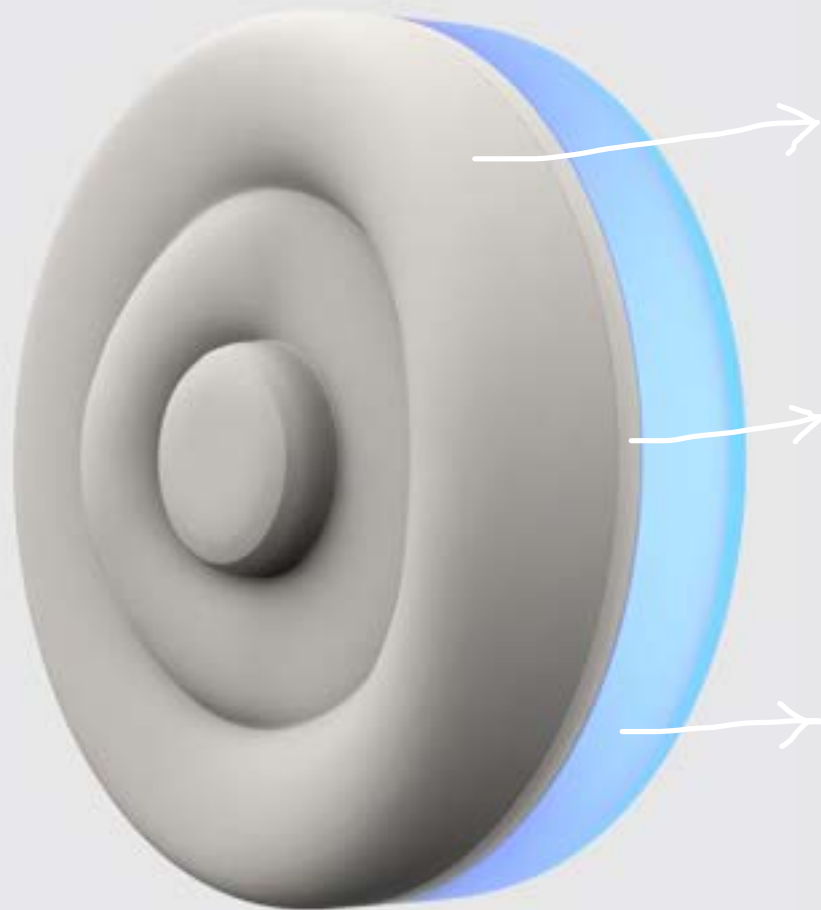
04

NeoPixel Ring

Displays a calming blue breathing light for anxiety and indicates connection and battery status.



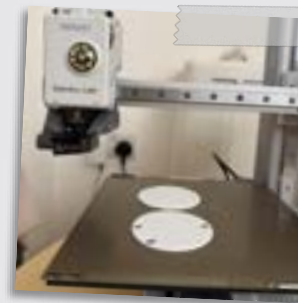
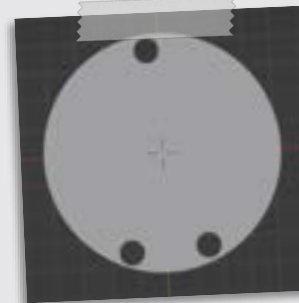
Circuit design, shell fabrication, and code were developed and tested in-house.



01

Silicone Rubber.

Used for buttons interface—soft, springy, durable, water- and chemical-resistant, and safe for skin. Prevents accidental presses and comes in various colours.



02

PLA (to be replaced with *PP*).

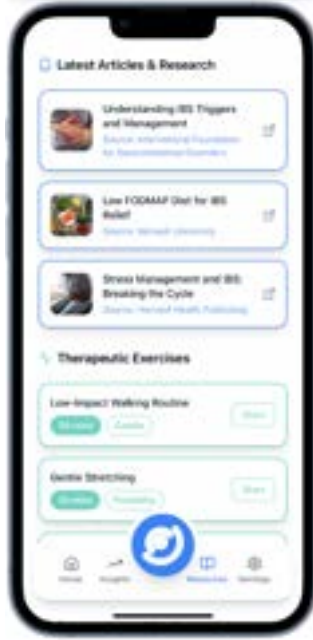
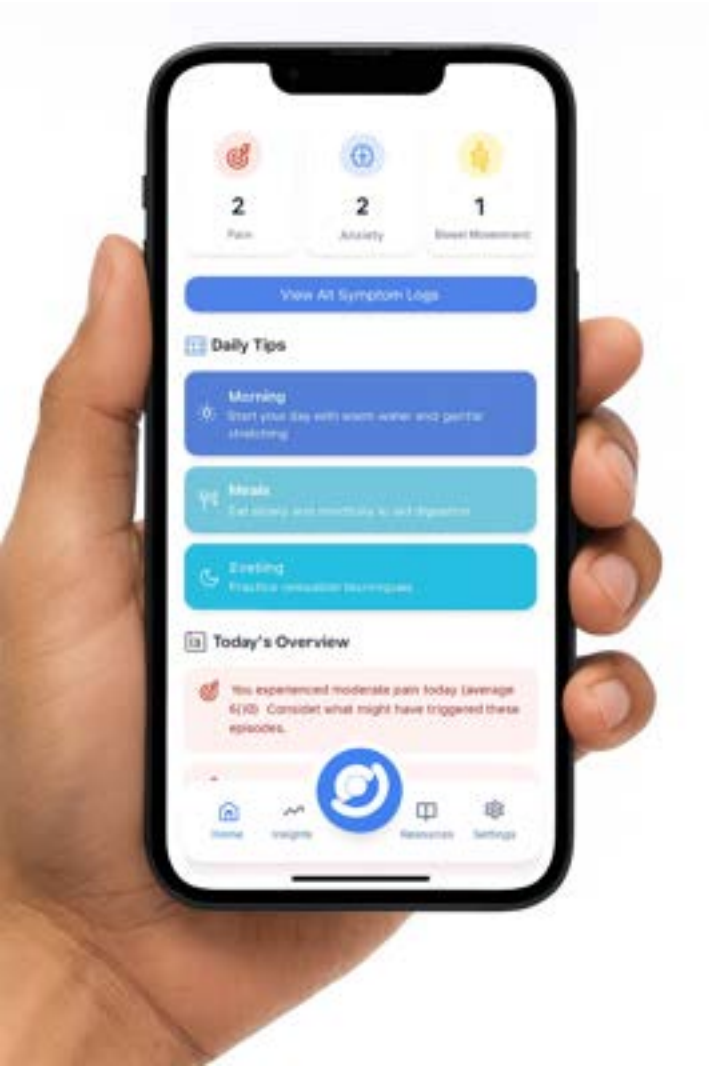
A 2mm PLA layer supports the silicone in prototypes. Final version uses PP for its durability, heat resistance, and cost-effectiveness.



03

SLA Resin (to be replaced with *PP*).

Translucent SLA resin base allows light diffusion in prototypes. Will be replaced with PP for better durability and manufacturability.



FEATURE 01 • REFLECT

Targeted *Symptom* Logging.

Generates end-of-day questions based on daily inputs to reduce unnecessary tracking.

FEATURE 02 • INSIGHTS

Simple, Clear, Digestible *Insights*.

Uses color-coded, digestible text instead of complex graphs for easy understanding.

FEATURE 03 • RESOURCES

Tailored *Resources*.

Offers personalized content like articles, exercises, and recipes based on user needs.

FEATURE 04 • COMPILE

Doctor Sharing.

Allows users to compile and share data with healthcare providers for better support.

period.

A Tangible, Smart Menstrual Cycle Tracker

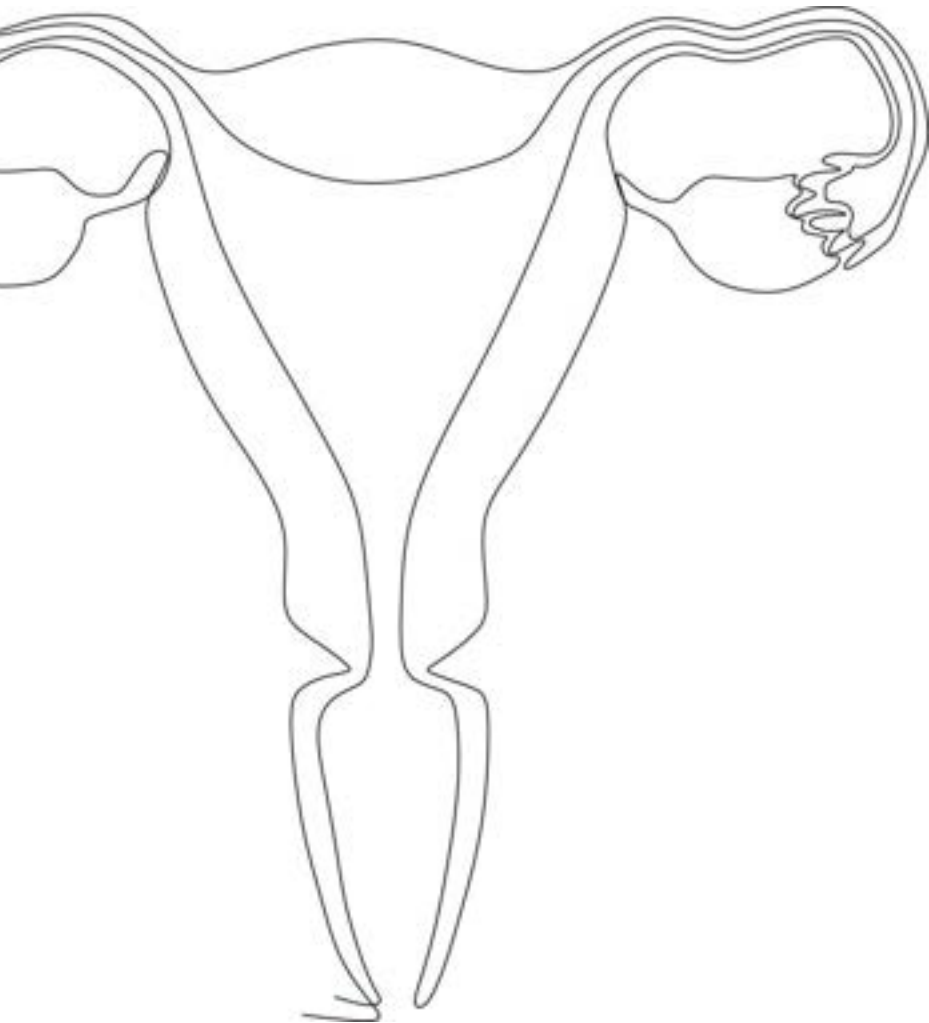
A physical product that visualises and tracks the menstrual cycle, combining light, voice, and daily interaction to make cycles visible, intuitive, and supportive.

September 2023 - May 2024

UX/UI · Tangible Interaction · Research-
Driven Design



Demonstration Video: <https://youtu.be/euJWdGEKTdw>



50%

of global population
menstruates

480

periods on average
experiences in a
woman's life

APPS ARE EASY TO FORGET

Most users abandon them after a few months due to lack of feedback and visual clarity.

NO PHYSICAL TRACKERS EXIST

Menstrual cycles remain invisible in everyday life, limiting awareness and shared understanding.

CYCLES VARY

Most tools assume a 28-day cycle, failing to support irregular menstruators.

GOAL Making cycle tracking visible, intuitive and supportive

“To design a product that helps women track and better understand their menstrual cycles by making cycle tracking visible, intuitive, and supportive.”

— SYNTHESISED FROM RESEARCH

01

Always *Visible* Status.

Light gradient showing the phase and indicator pointing on cycle day

02

***Personalised* Feedback.**

Artificial Intelligent Voice Assistant that provides hands-free personalised feedback

03

***Irregular* Cycles.**

Design that caters for people with irregular cycles

04

Emotional *Comfort*.

Soft, calming design that blends into the home

01
Glance



Colour shifts daily.
Readable across the room.

02
Auto - Turn



Colour shifts daily.
Readable across the room.

03
Fold



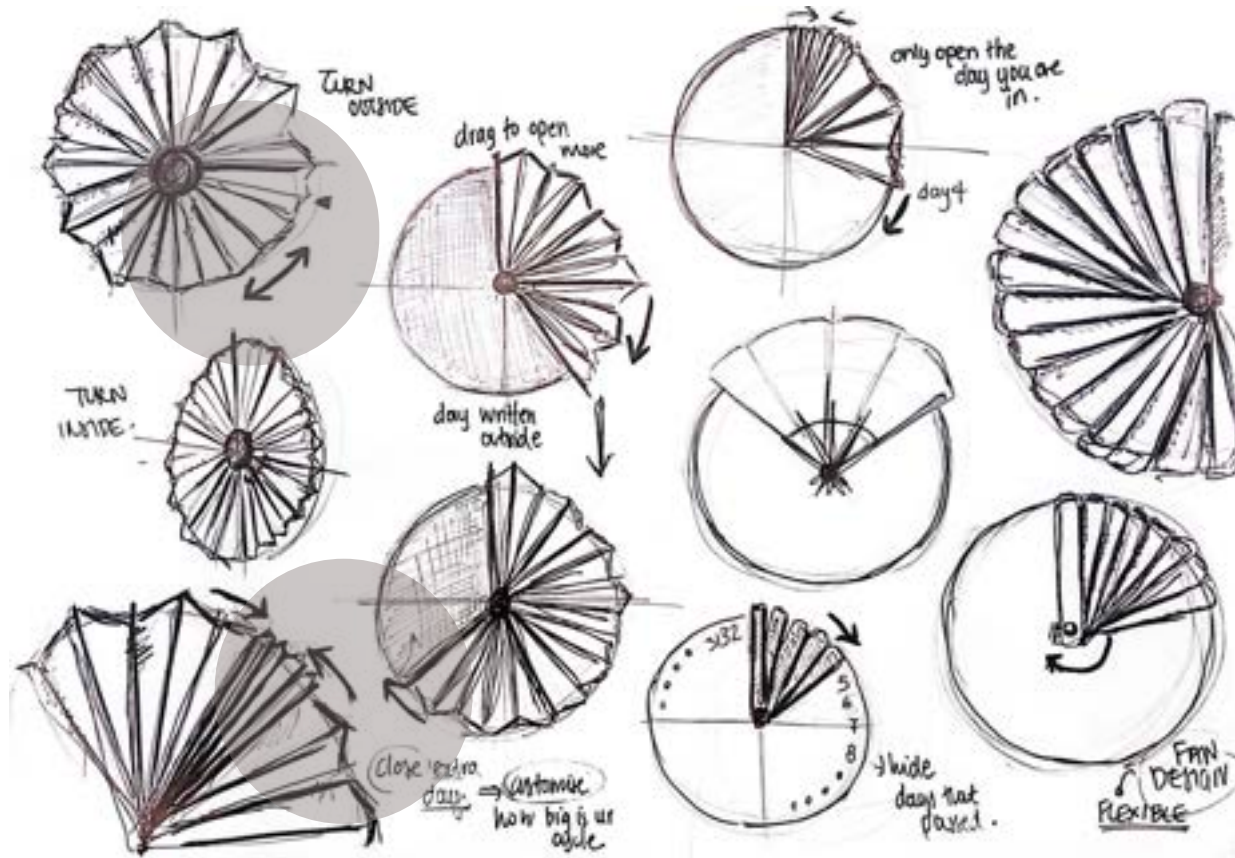
Each fold is one day. Tucks
to fit any 21-35 day cycle.

04
Ask

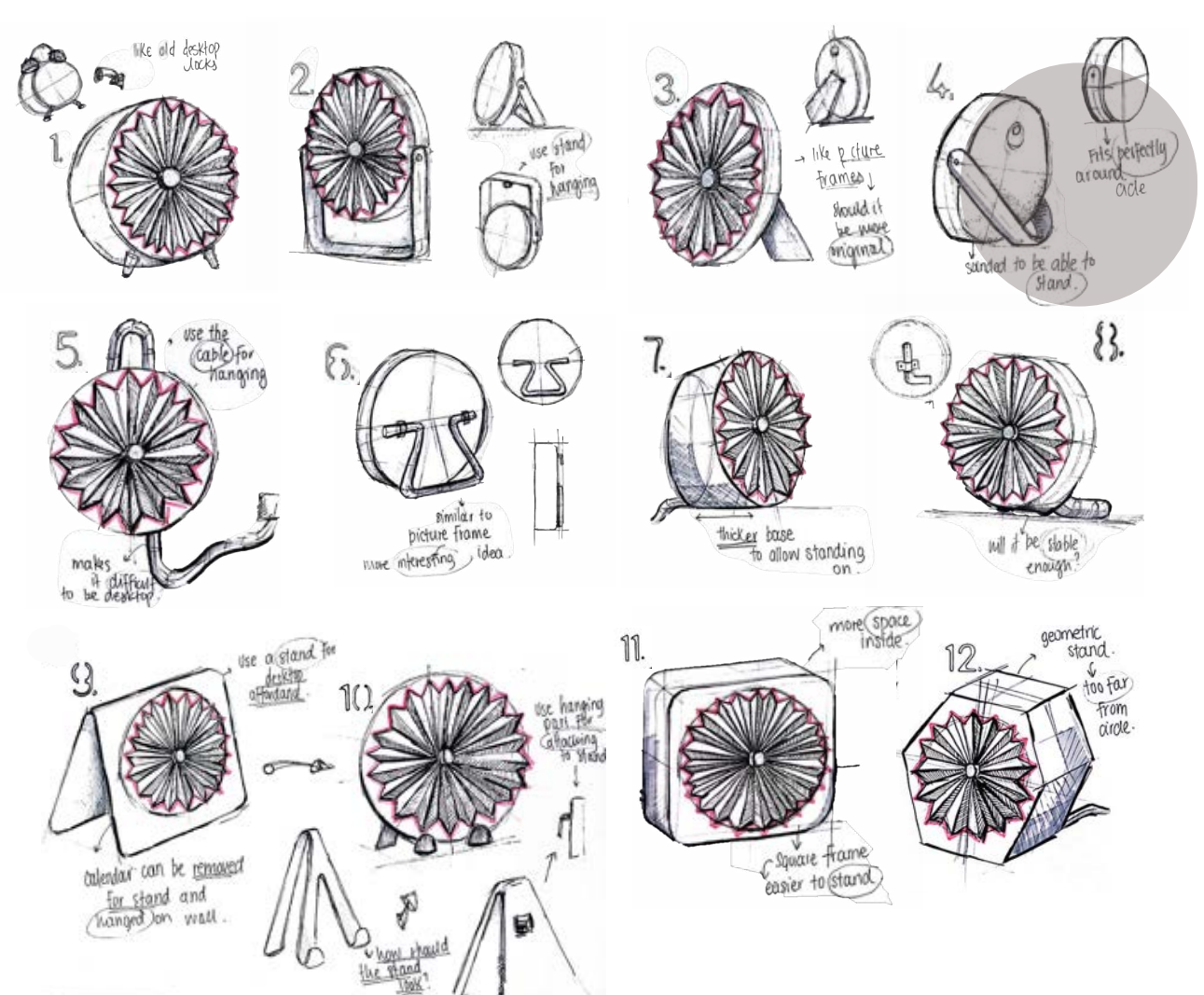


Luna (Voice Assistant) answers
cycle questions. Voice at the
bedside, text in the app.





After creating and testing several prototypes, an *accordion fan* form was implemented, recognizing its potential for modularity and, therefore, for tracking different cycle lengths. This concept resulted in a calendar *comprising 35 days and 70 folds*, with days 21-35 representing the gap between the shortest and longest cycles, equipped with magnets for folding away unwanted days.



Both hanging and desktop options were explored after user feedback revealed diverse preferences. The final design features a semicircular handle, providing stability on flat surfaces and allowing the product to *hang flush against the wall when closed.*



01

Raspberry Pi 3B+ .

Processes all code, handles voice recognition and internet connectivity.



02

NeoPixel Ring.

Displays a light gradient. Connected to the Raspberry Pi via GPIO pins.



03

Servo Motor.

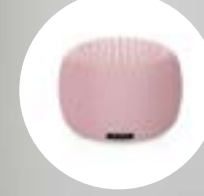
Rotates a dial with a fan to show the correct cycle day every 24 hours.



04

Microphone.

Captures voice input. Activates only with the wake word.



05

Speaker.

Outputs sound so users can hear the assistant's replies.



FEATURE 01 • LOGGING

Remote *Interaction*.

Log data without speaking aloud.



FEATURE 02 • HISTORY

Symptom *History*.

View and edit past entries.



FEATURE 03 • COMPILE

Doctor *Sharing*.

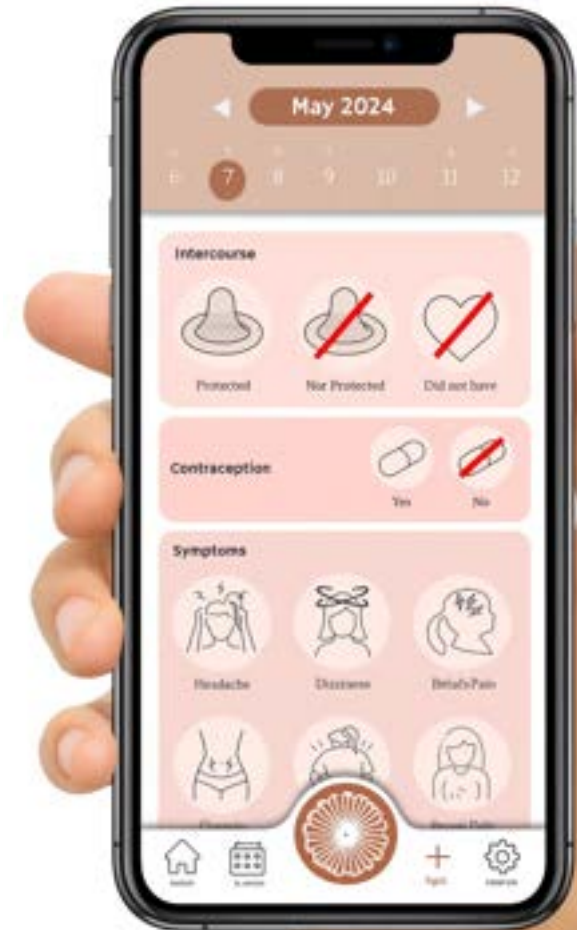
Export cycle summaries for healthcare.



DECISION 01 • UI

Interface *Aesthetic*.

Echoes the physical fan design.





Milo

A connected memory game for people apart

Inspired by the classic Simon game, Milo enables playful, screen-free interaction between loved ones living apart — using light, sound, and rhythm to foster joyful connection.

January- May 2023
In collaboration with Quentin Bachelot

Connected Play • Tangible UX • Emotional
Technology • Interaction Design

92%

of international students in the US reported missing the familiarities of home. (UNESCO)

50%

believed that not having family and friends impacted their academic performance. (UNESCO)

70% of men & 55% of women

(ages 18-34) say games help them stay connected with friends and family. (ESA)

PROBLEM Living apart often weakens spontaneous emotional connection.

INSIGHT

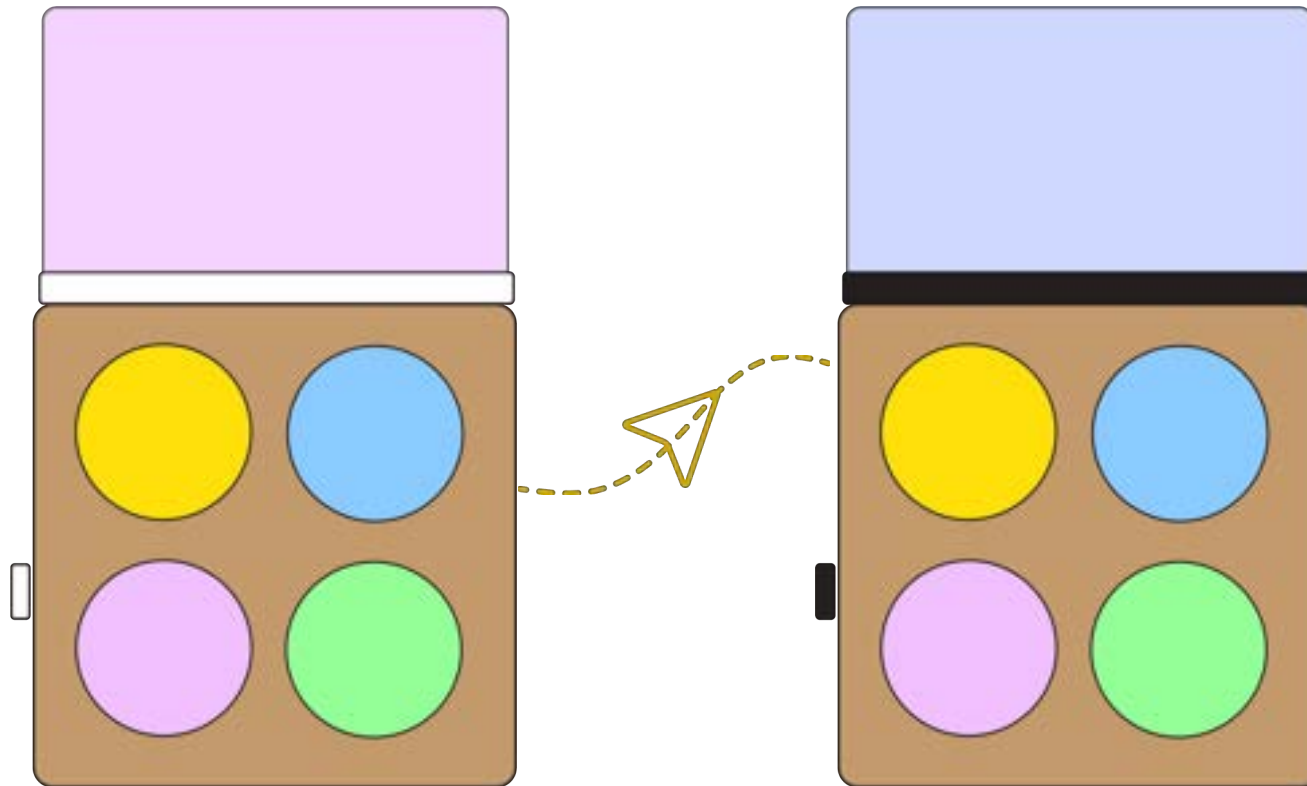
People crave playful, emotional connection — but most games rely on screens and visuals, not presence.

OPPORTUNITY

Create a tangible, emotionally rich game that lets people “talk” in light, rhythm, and memory — without a screen.

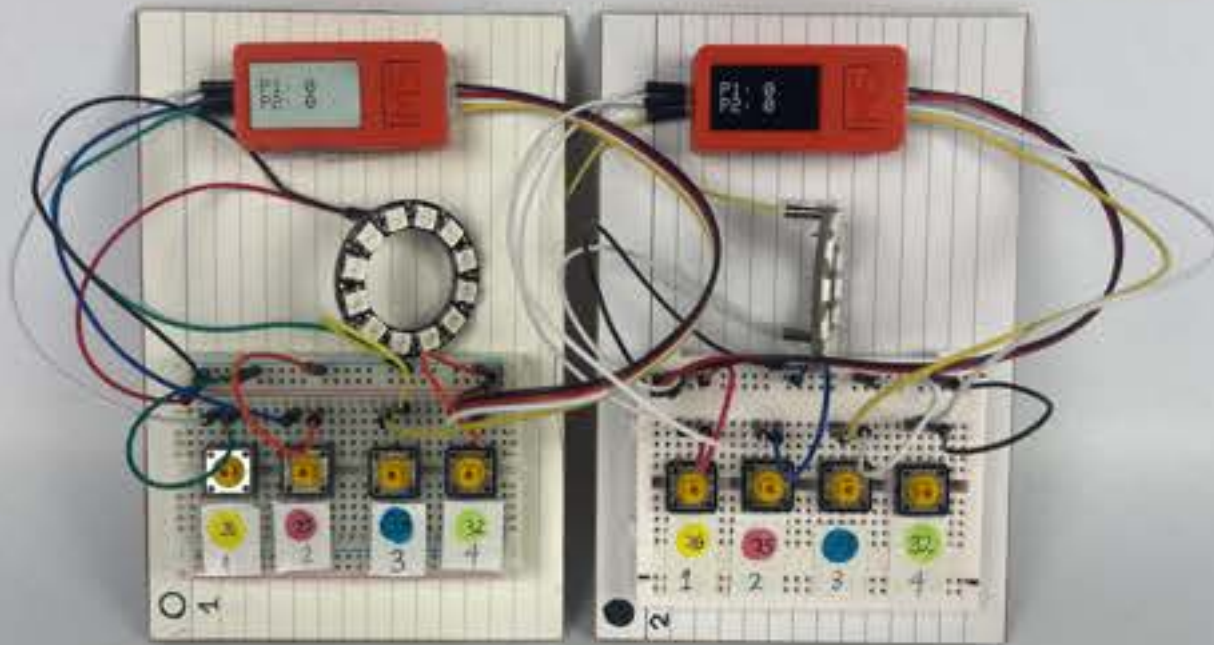
how it *works*?

MILO 03



↗
A rhythmic “conversation” — played across time and space.

- **Start the sequence**
Player 1 taps three colours to begin
- **Receive the sequence**
A blue light signals it's your turn. Press side button to play.
- **Watch and remember it**
Lights display the latest sequence
- **Repeat it**
Reproduce the pattern with the coloured buttons.
- **Nailed it?**
Flashing green = success! Add one more colour and send it back.
- **Miss it?**
Flashing red = new round. Other player scores and starts over.



Circuit design, shell fabrication, and code were developed and tested in-house.

01

M5 Stick C Plus – Processor.

ESP32 board with internet connectivity allows for the game to progress to be stored online for remote gameplay.

02

M5 Stick C Plus – Battery.

M5 Stick's built-in LiPo battery allows for portable use and charging.

03

M5 Stick C Plus – Screen.

M5 Stick's display used to show the ongoing score.

04

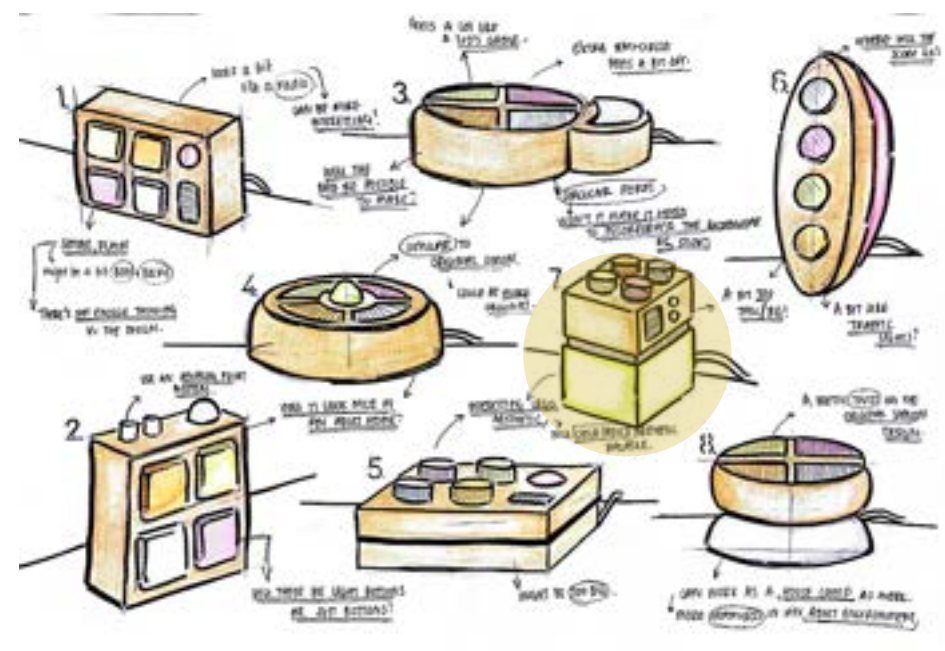
Buttons .

Four buttons associated to four colours allow the player to enter different colour combinations.

05

NeoPixel Ring

Light serving as an indicator (blue = your turn, green = correct, red = wrong, etc.) and for communicating the colour sequence to be repeated to the player.



01 Fixed object. Initial designs focused on a fixed object to encourage daily use through visibility	02 User Testing. Young adults showed a strong preference for a handheld, smartphone – like format	03 The pivot. We shifted to a hybrid model: a portable object with a dock	04 The balance. Balancing spontaneity and routine in one connected object.
--	---	---	--





DECISION 01 • COLOUR

Playful, not childish.

Soft pastel hues with neutral bases strike a balance between fun and maturity — suitable for all ages.

DECISION 02 • FORM

Tactile, *warm*, and familiar.

Rounded forms, wooden components, and a matte texture invite touch and comfort.

ENGAGEMENT

Designed for *sensory* engagement

Smooth button press, gradient lighting, and subtle sound create a calming, delightful experience.



WHAT WORKED

"I liked how it felt like a conversation with my loved ones, but without needing to text or talk."

WHAT WORKED

"I love how nostalgic and calming it feels. I would actually use it with long-distance friends."



WHAT DIDN'T

"It is a bit unclear that is waiting for me to add a colour after I get the sequence right."

GAME DESIGN

"Right amount of difficulty to make it engaging and enjoyable"

Feedback clarified the need for *clearer turn-taking and confirmation cues* in the light/sound language.

VATTENKANNA

A Greywater Watering Can for IKEA

Designed to collect water used during dishwashing, Vattenkanna encourages reuse and reduces domestic water waste — while aligning with IKEA's philosophy of sustainable everyday living.

January- May 2023
Brief provided by IKEA

Sustainable Design • Circularity • IKEA
Collaboration • Design for Manufacturing •
CAD



PROBLEM Every time we handwash dishes, 30 litres of clean water go straight down the drain, contributing to avoidable water and carbon emissions.

6%
of CO2 emissions
in UK are from
water use

5%
*of domestic water use in
UK comes from washing
dishes*

50%
*of UK household
never use a
dishwasher*

300L
*of weekly water wasted
per UK household from
handwashing dishes*



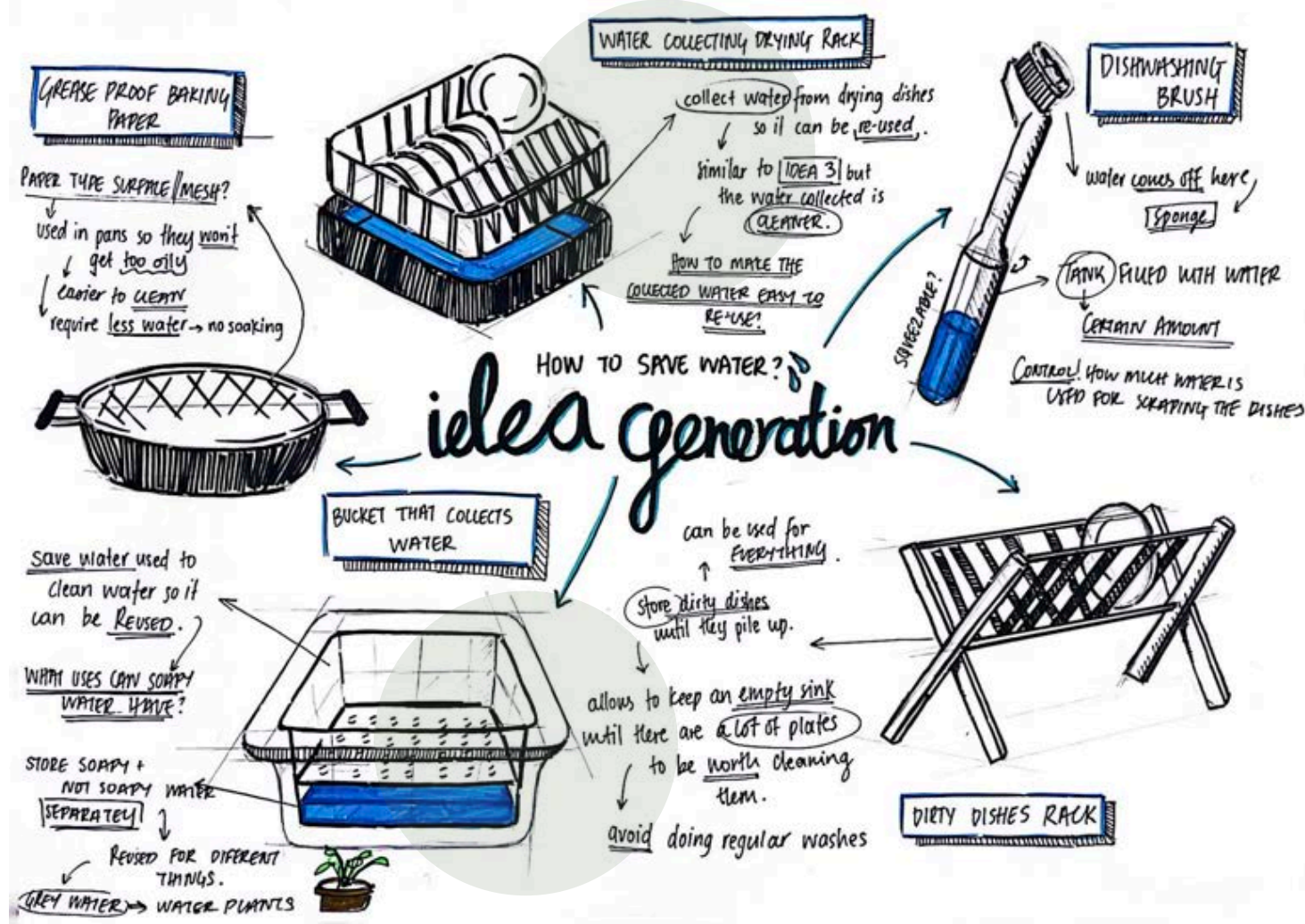
We documented 15+ kitchen sinks around the UK to understand typical sink environments and dishwashing behaviours.

INSIGHT

Despite high awareness of sustainability, water collection is rarely integrated into kitchen routines — especially during dishwashing.

HOW MIGHT WE

How might we integrate water reuse into everyday habits without disrupting people's existing routines?

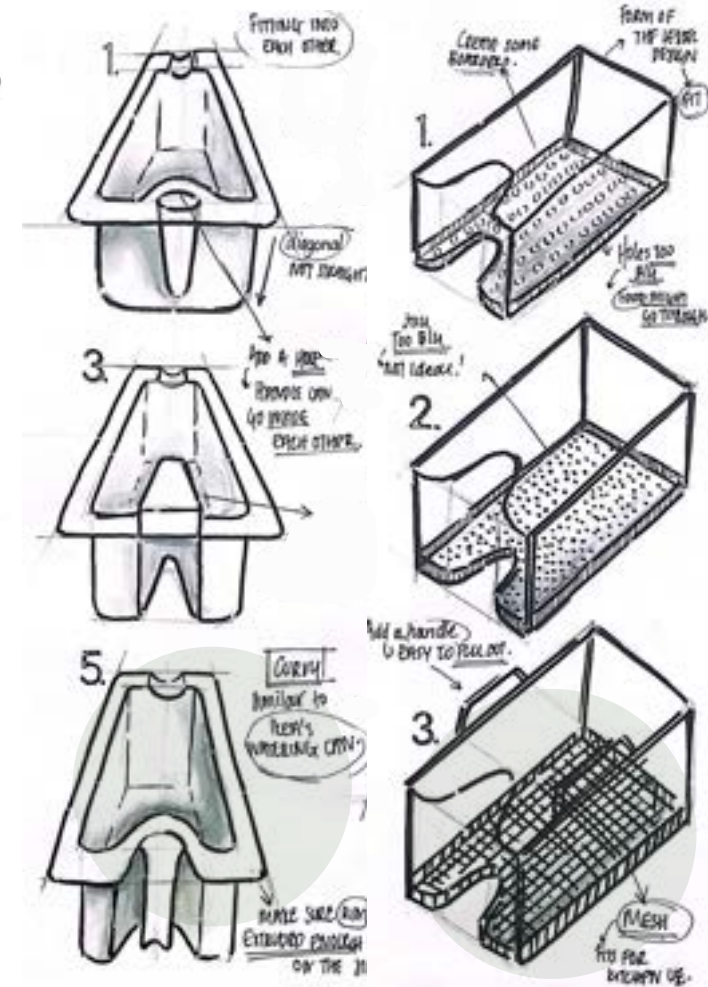
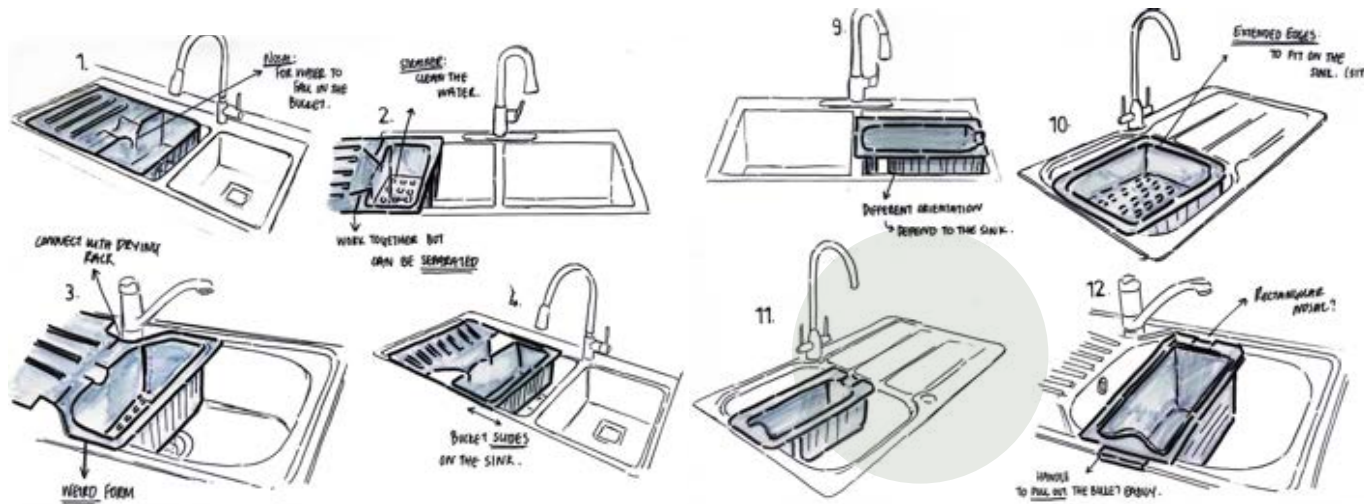


OPPORTUNITY

A simple, low-effort tool to collect and reuse greywater from dishwashing — for watering plants, washing the car, or other household tasks.

WHY IKEA?

Vattenkanna fits IKEA's values of accessible, scalable, and joyful sustainability — designed for affordable production and everyday use.



DECISION 01 • FORM

Form Explorations.

Designed to fit seamlessly in the sink and collect greywater from both handwashing dishes and from the drying rack

DECISION 02 • RIM

Ergonomic Rim.

The rim geometry was shaped for balance, grip, and easy removal — even when wet.

DECISION 03 • HANDLE

Portable and Familiar.

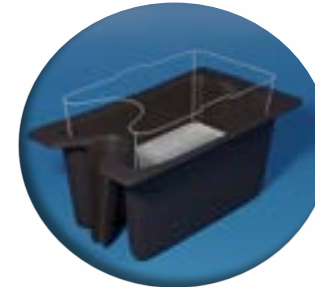
The object invites users to pick it up and pour with a single gesture — making the reuse action feel natural and intentional.



DECISION 04 • DIMENSIONS

Sink Compatibility.

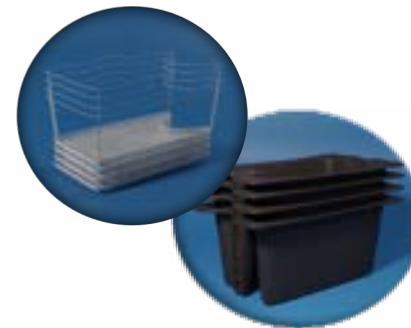
Vattenkanna was modelled to nest within standard UK sink basins (34 x 40 x 20 cm) without interrupting the flow of washing, ensuring ease of integration into existing routines.



DECISION 05 • STRAINER

Built-in *Filtration*.

A removable mesh insert filters out food particles and debris — making greywater safe for reuse.



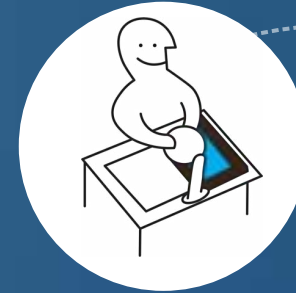
DECISION 06 • PRODUCTION

Efficient *Manufacturing*

Designed for stack ability and minimal part complexity, Vattenkanna reduces shipping volume and manufacturing costs — aligned with IKEA's sustainability goals.



Collect



Greywater from rinsing and scraping falls into the vessel rather than down the drain.

Strain



Tip the food bits into the bin. The water left in the vessel is now clean enough to reuse.

Pour



Water plants, wash the car, or fill a bucket. Whatever the household needs.



DECISION 07 • MATERIAL

***Sustainable* Material Choice.**

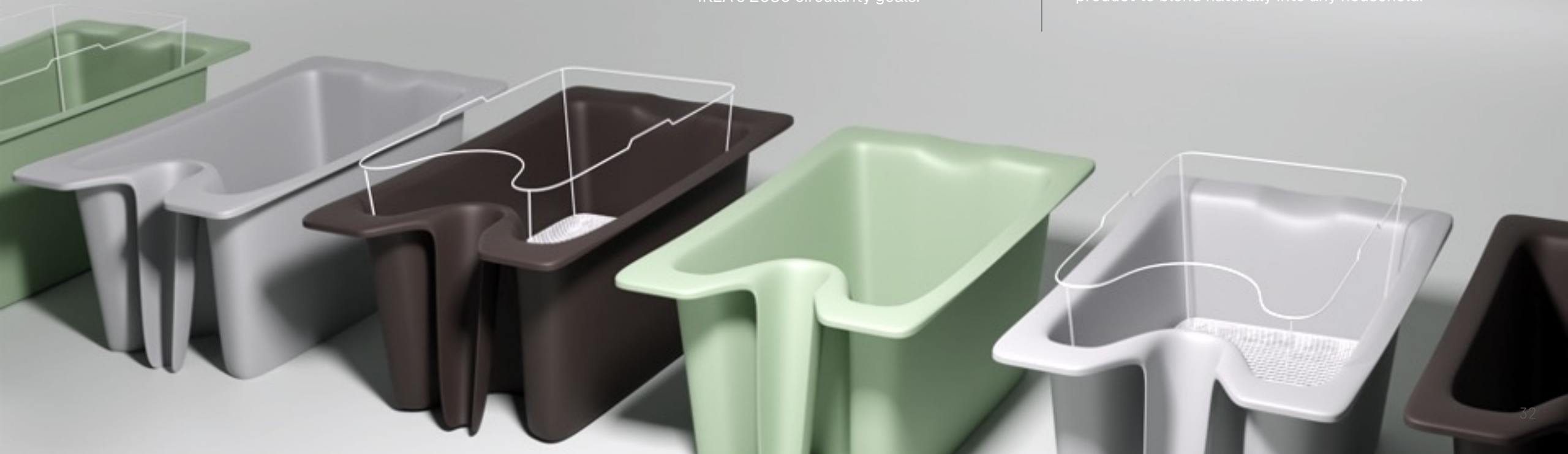
Made from 100% recycled PET plastic — waterproof, durable, and aligned with IKEA's 2030 circularity goals.

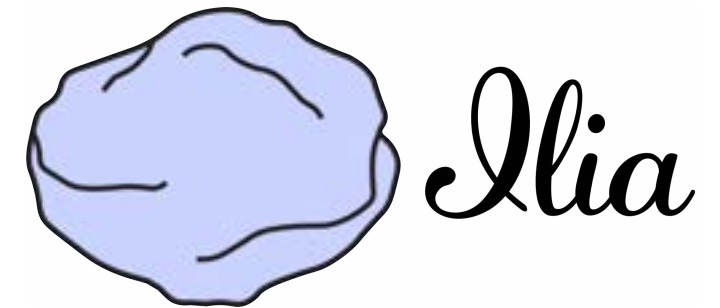


DECISION 08 • COLOUR

***Colour* Strategy.**

Neutral tones (light grey, soft green, dark brown) inspired by IKEA kitchenware allow the product to blend naturally into any household.





A breathing lamp for emotional regulation during studying

A tactile, interactive lamp designed to reduce anxiety and encourage mindful breaks during study through light-based breathing guidance.

January- May 2022
In collaboration with Quentin Bachelot

Mental Health · Tangible UX · Emotional Technology
· Prototyping · User Testing

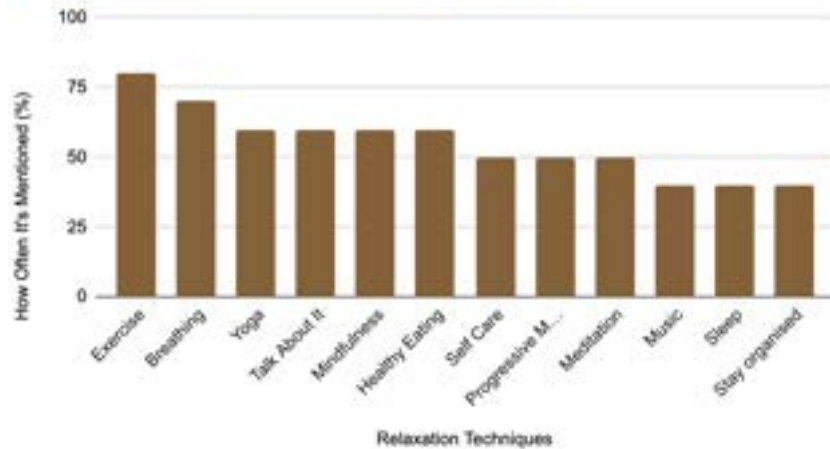
63%

of university students in the US experience increased anxiety post COVID19, reporting that it impacts their ability to focus (APA)

62%

of university students in the UK report experiencing peak anxiety while studying/working. (Independent Survey)

Most Recommended/Discussed Techniques



PROBLEM Increased anxiety and stress in university students

INSIGHT

University students are experiencing high levels of stress especially when studying and need managing tools. *How might we design stillness into the study routine?*

OPPORTUNITY

Create an interactive desk lamp that naturally integrates breathing guidance into the study environment, helping students reduce stress and improve concentration—without relying on screens or apps.



The interaction is subtle and intuitive, encouraging breaks and deeper focus without screens or noise.

MODE 1

Acts as a desk lamp, touch to activate breathing.

MODE 2

Turns blue every 2h, reminds you to take a break.

Touch

Activated breathing guide

Breathing

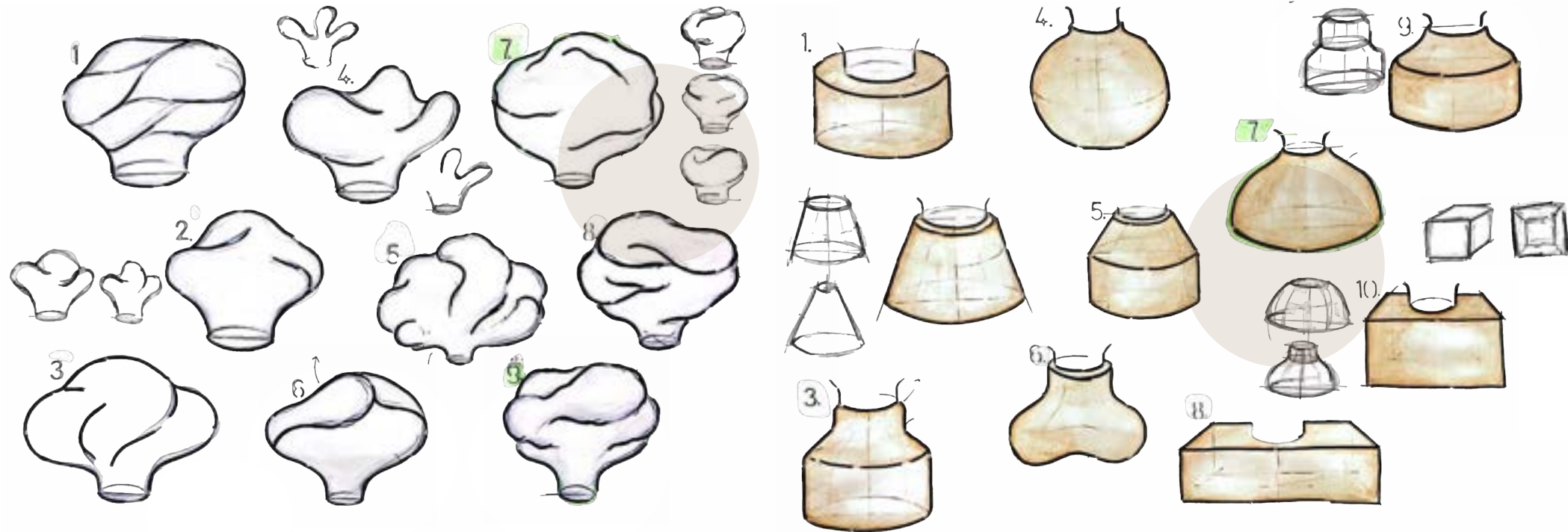
Blue pulse, 5s inhale/ 5s exhale

Time

2 mins guided cycle, but can continue if desired

Remove Hand

Stops pulsing



DECISION 01 • FORM

Ergonomic Base.

Dome-shaped wooden base supports natural hand placement and comfort, with two sizes developed to suit different hand sizes.

DECISION 02 • MATERIAL

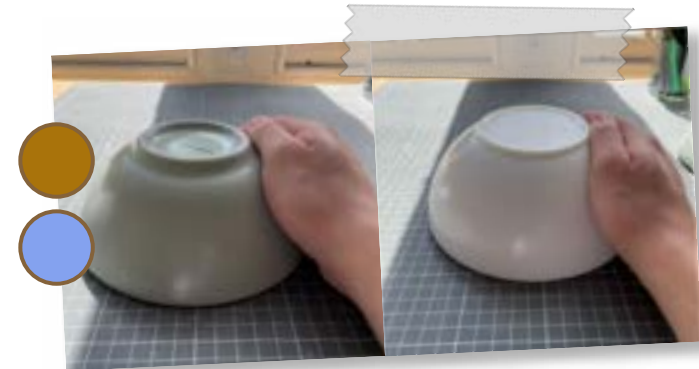
Tactile Interaction.

Soft wood invites gentle hand contact, encouraging users to engage with the breathing rhythm in an intuitive, calming way.

DECISION 03 • FORM

Glass Cloud Form.

The organic, cloud-like glass top diffuses light softly, reinforcing the emotional and sensory calm of the product.





DECISION 04 • WOOD

Wooden Base Construction.

Layered MDF was lathe-turned into a dome and hollowed to fit electronics, with drilled channels for wiring.



DECISION 05 • GLASS

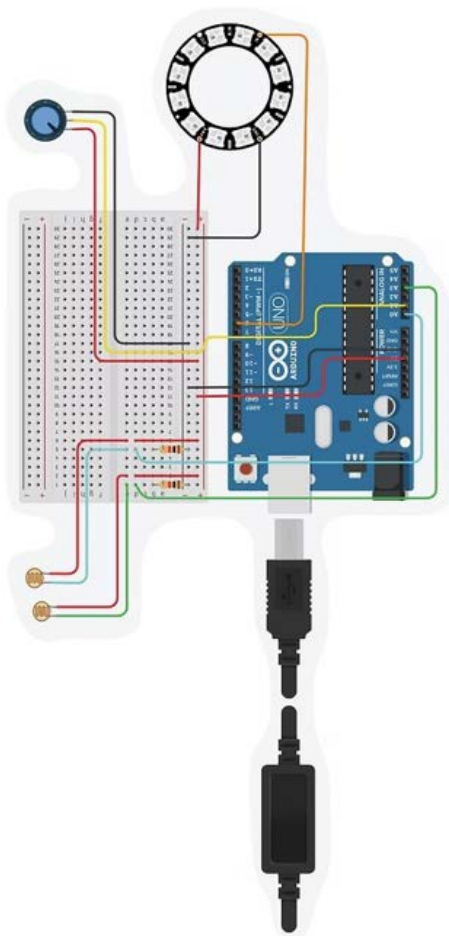
Glass, Diffuser Crafting.

Rounded forms, wooden components, and a matte texture invite touch and comfort.

COLLABORATION

Collaborative Making Process

The process was a collaboration between our design team and the expert glassmakers at ECA, who assisted with the hot glass blowing



01

NeoPixel Ring

Emits yellow light in lamp mode and shifts to a soft pulsing blue for breathing guidance, following a sine wave rhythm.

02

Potentiometer.

Allows switching between modes by rotating left or right.

03

Arduino Uno.

Controls all components and animations, including the sine wave timing for the breathing guide.

04

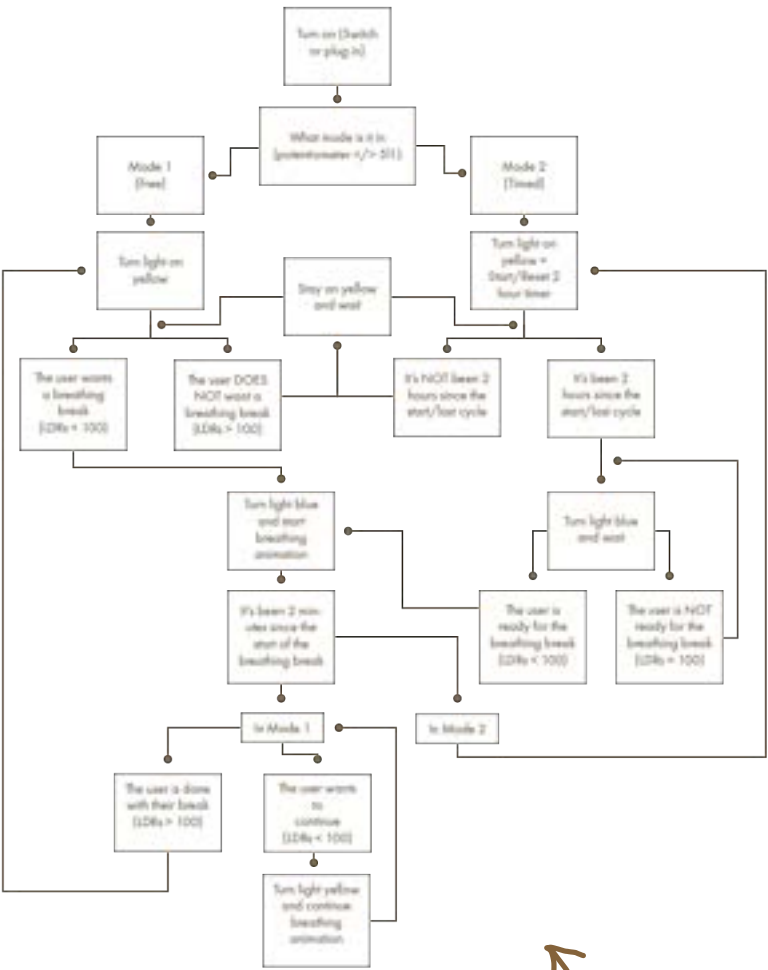
LDR Sensor .

Detect when hands are placed on the wooden base by sensing the drop in ambient light. When blocked, they trigger the breathing animation.

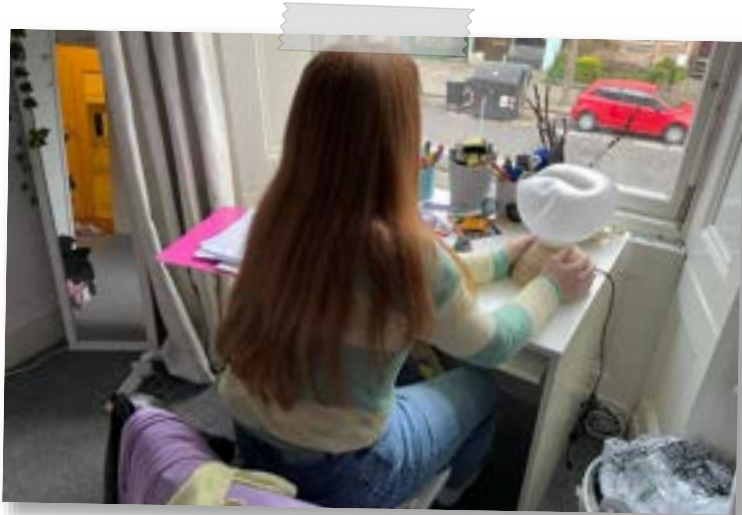
05

External Power Switch

Enables the lamp to be easily turned on and off.



Coded on Arduino Uno using sine wave logic for breathing animations. Flow diagram illustrates interaction logic and transitions between modes.



WHAT WORKED

"It really helped me take regular breaks — my study sessions actually felt more productive when I used it."

WHAT WORKED

"I like the simple, calming design. It fits right into any study space and feels intuitive to use."

WHAT DIDN'T

"Switching between modes could be clearer, and the sensors are a bit too visible and sometimes unreliable."



AirFlux

A compact, handle-free hair dryer for intuitive, sustainable use

AirFlux rethinks the hair dryer through ergonomic grip, reduced bulk, and repairable design — combining portability with everyday practicality.

September - December 2021

Redesign · Circularity · Object Teardown ·
Design for Manufacture · Design for
Repairability





WHY THIS PRODUCT?

The Remington hair dryer is a somewhat famous and inexpensive hair dryer used by many people that could be improved to better serve its users.

WHAT WE FOUND?

- Glued shut, no screws → non-repairable
- Large form dominated by bulky handle
- Complex inner assembly for a basic function

OPPORTUNITY

Minimal screws and heavy use of glue made repairs nearly impossible. The handle adds most of the bulk -*removing it* offers a path to a more compact, ergonomic form.

62%

wished their dryer was lighter & smaller

30%

wished they could change how it's held

69%

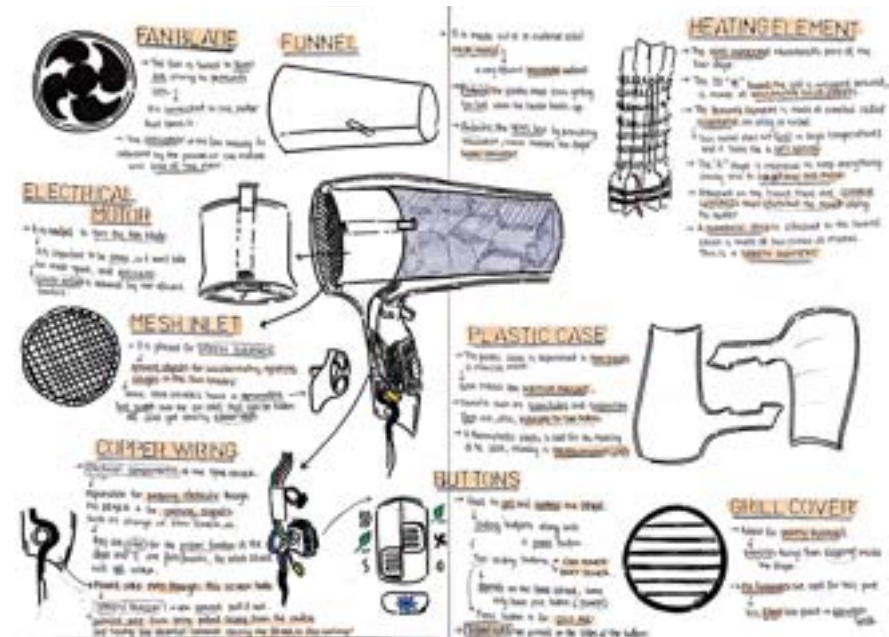
said it's difficult to open & fix

PROBLEM Users want lighter, easier-to-hold dryers — and the ability to fix them.

A study of current models showed standardised form and CMF — **long handles dominate**, despite usability complaints.

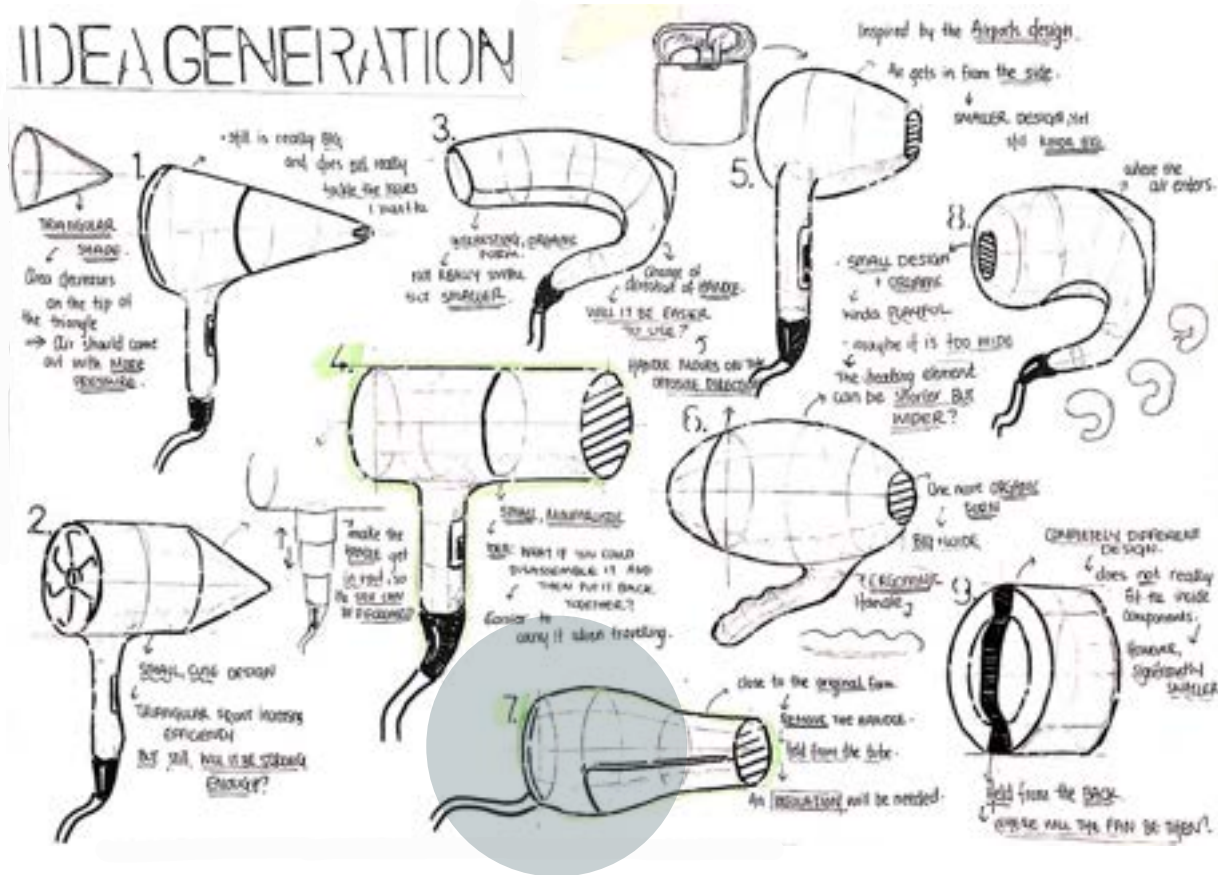


A study of current models showed standardised form and CMF — long handles dominate, despite usability complaints.



OPPORTUNITY

How might we rethink the form and assembly of hair dryers to better align with user needs and reparability?



DECISION 01 • FORM

Handle-Free Design .

AirFlux eliminates the traditional handle to reduce bulk and weight, making the dryer more compact and travel-friendly.

DECISION 02 • FORM

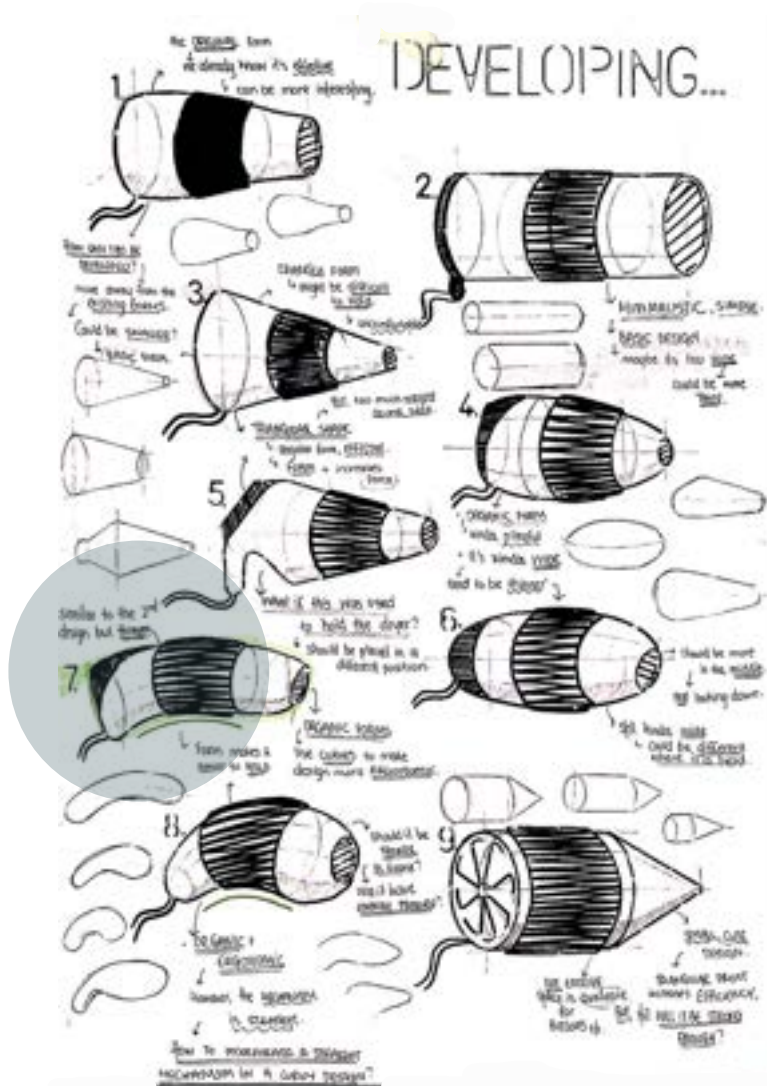
Ergonomic Grip .

The product is held directly by the air outlet tube, offering a new, intuitive grip that improves control and ease of use.

DECISION 03 • SIZE

Optimised *Power-to-Size* Ratio .

By keeping the core system intact while removing unnecessary parts, AirFlux maintains high performance in a much smaller form.



01

Heat Protection *Sleeve*.

A thermal insulating sleeve was added to prevent burns when holding the dryer by the tube, its hottest part.

02

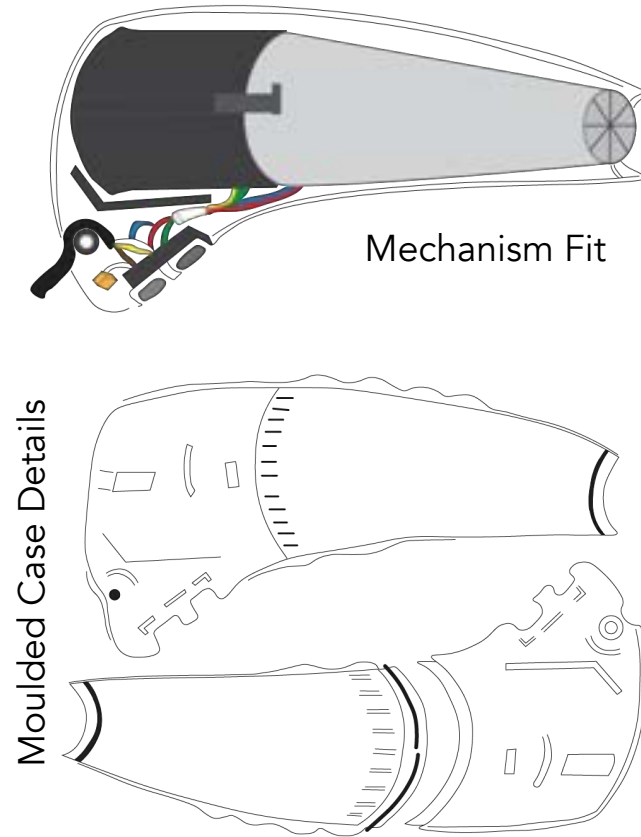
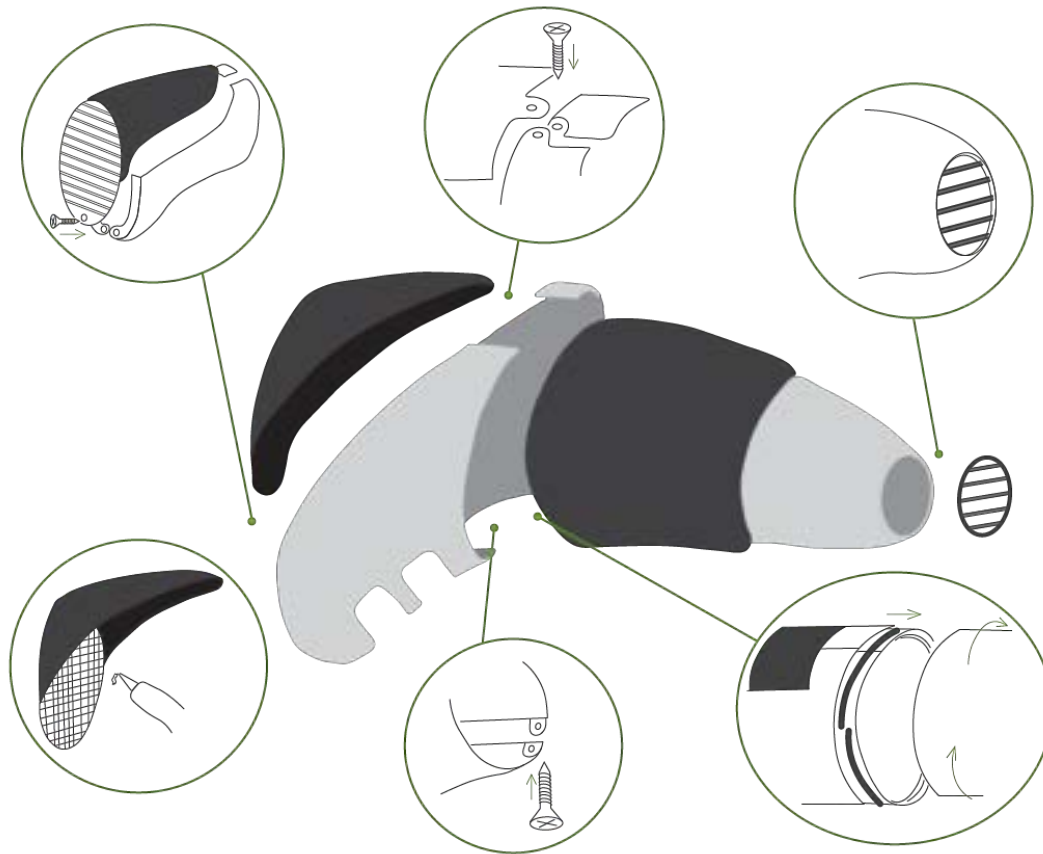
Ergonomic *Sleeve* Testing.

Multiple prototypes were tested to design a sleeve shape that offers a safe, comfortable, and ergonomic grip.

03

Integrated *Compact* Design

The sleeve was carefully designed to fit the compact new form of AirFlux without compromising aesthetics or usability.



DECISION 04 • CONSTRUCTION

Design for *Repairability*.

Components were reworked to allow easy disassembly—glue was replaced with screws for better user access to electronics.

DECISIONS 05 • FIT

Compatible Internal Layout.

AirFlux's form fits the existing Remington mechanism with minimal changes, only altering the casing and internal placement.

Silicone Cord Rubber

- Insulator → does not conduct electricity.
- Flexible Plastic → can be bended and moved without the cord being destroyed.

Aluminium Mesh Inlet

- Cut to create a circular mesh screen to act as filter
- Polyweld adhesive can be used to connect mesh to plastic case due to its strength.

Silicone Sleeve

- Material Enhancer – can be added above PP
- Long Thermal Conductivity (Heat Resistant) → good insulator
- Great Heat Range which gives thermal stability to avoid damage when overheating
- Warm, soft, rubbery feel, ideal for holding

Polypropylene Case

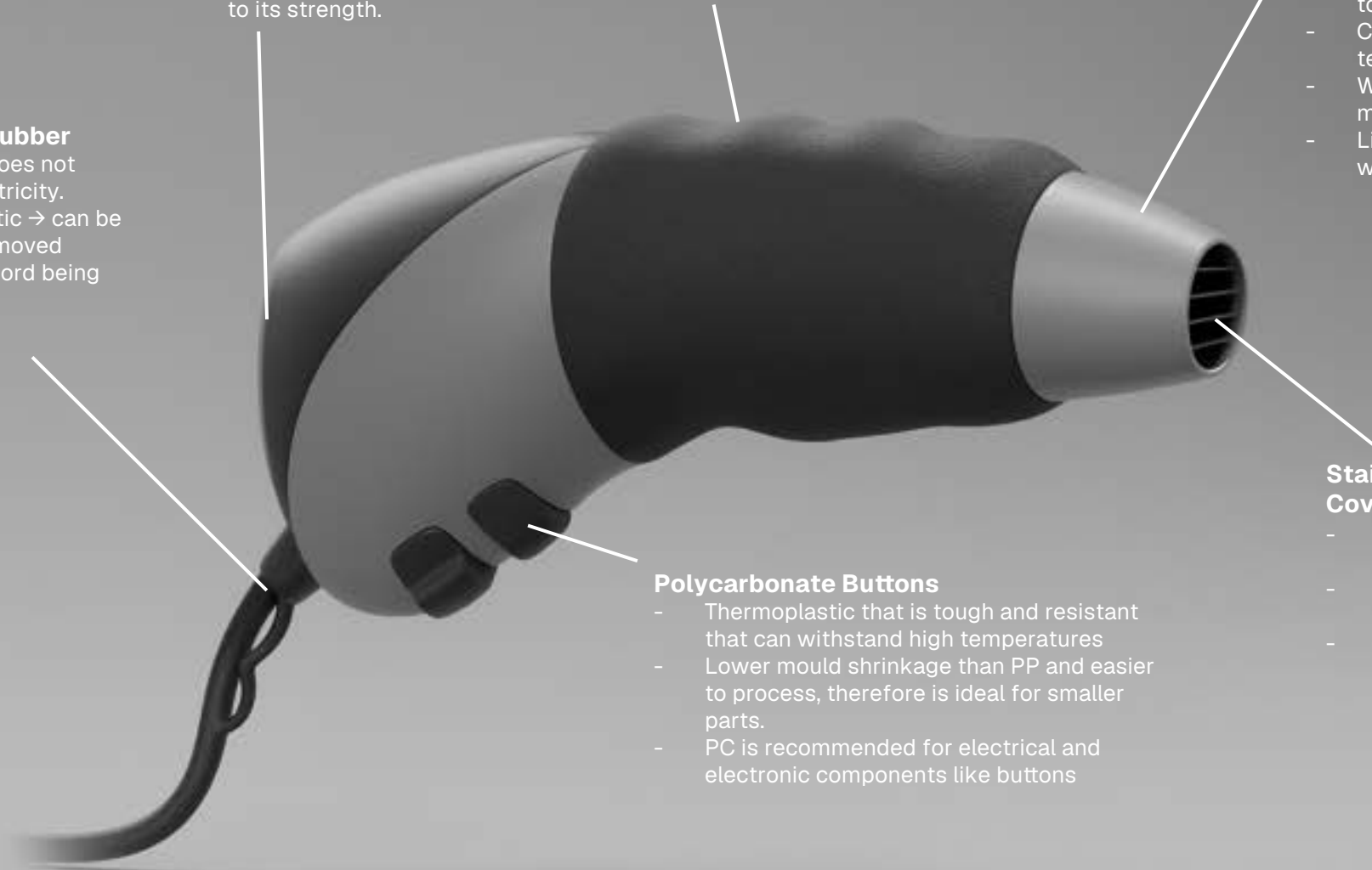
- Thermoplastic polymer that is tough and resistant
- Can withstand high temperatures
- Water repellent → ideal for moist environments
- Light material to minimise weight

Stainless Steel Grill Cover

- Durable and Cheap material
- Does not get destroyed in high temperatures
- Chrome Platted to become water resistant

Polycarbonate Buttons

- Thermoplastic that is tough and resistant that can withstand high temperatures
- Lower mould shrinkage than PP and easier to process, therefore is ideal for smaller parts.
- PC is recommended for electrical and electronic components like buttons



Thank you for considering my application!

EMAIL

nefelilem@gmail.com

PHONE

+44 (0) 7766 964 868

INSTAGRAM,

@nefelilemessioudesign

WEBSITE

nefelilemessiou.com

let's make something →